other online criminals.[12] Corporations even wondered whether the NSA was collecting information about the companies themselves. Smith said in an interview, "For the industry as a whole, it caused everyone to ask whether we knew as much as we thought."[13]

> "What the government wants is something they never had before. They want total awareness. The question is, is that something we should be allowing?"[14]
>
> —*Edward Snowden*

As a result of the leaks, Google, Yahoo, and other tech companies began installing expensive encryption software along their fiber-optic lines to stop mass collection of data traffic. Some Internet companies began routing Internet traffic through other companies' computer servers to decrease eavesdropping. These safeguards meant that if the NSA wanted information, it would have to ask for it through a FISA court or figure out a way to get around encryption one communication at a time.

With companies using more encryption and other technical tools, the Internet was becoming a less user-friendly place for the NSA. Meanwhile, from his home in Russia, Snowden wondered whether the United States would ever be a friendly place for him again.

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